Open Science
Foundation

Advancing science through openness.

The Open Science Foundation brand system.
Form, language and application.



BRAND GUIDE & MOTION ASSETS

10 September 2026

A WORKING IDENTITY SYSTEM

Start with what is already ours.

This guide brings the existing Open Science Foundation identity into one practical reference. The website theme and original masters remain the design authority.

01 Foundation 03 to 04
Purpose, language and the brand idea

02 The mark 05 to 11
Original masters, selection and careful use

03 Colour 12 to 14
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Typography, layout, graphics, motion and images

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Digital, print, social and partnerships

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Production, quick reference and sources

DEFAULT / 01 OPEN EDITORIAL. SELECTED 8 SEPTEMBER 2026. THIS EDITION / 10 SEPTEMBER 2026.

THE BRAND IDEA

Scientific knowledge as a global commons.

The Open Science Foundation supports open research, shared infrastructure and the people who put open science into practice.

The identity begins with an open, continuous process. Dots gather, separate and form new relationships. A stable name gives that movement a clear institutional voice.

01

Openness

Make knowledge accessible.

02

Transparency

Share methods and processes.

03

Collaboration

Work through shared infrastructure.

04

Reproducibility

Enable others to build on the work.

PUBLIC POSITIONING AND VALUES / OPENING.SCIENCE. SOURCES ON PAGE 26. FULL DESIGN ATTRIBUTION ON PAGE 27.

VOICE & TERMINOLOGY

Clear words. Specific claims.

ONE-SENTENCE INTRODUCTION

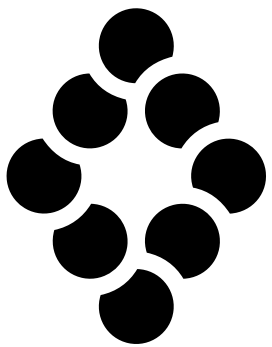
The Open Science Foundation is a Swiss foundation that funds and conducts open science.

Put the work first.	Name the project, activity or finding. Use plain language and explain specialised terms.
Keep names distinct.	Write “Open Science Foundation” in full, then “the foundation”. Never shorten it to “OSF”, which search engines read as the Open Science Framework. The Open Science Institute (OSI) is funded and governed by the foundation.
Let evidence set the tone.	Use verified facts, dates and quotations. Say what is known and what remains uncertain. Avoid inflated claims.
Write as a colleague.	Use short to medium declarative sentences. Use “we” when the foundation speaks. Keep titles and statements left aligned.

USE THE FULL ORGANISATION NAME ON FIRST MENTION. RETAIN PRODUCTION COPY EXACTLY WHEN REUSING IT.

RECOGNITION BEGINS HERE

One name. A distinctive form.



Open Science
Foundation

THE DEFAULT

The full foundation signature.

Use the original positive lockup on a quiet light surface. Keep the mark and the two-line wordmark together.

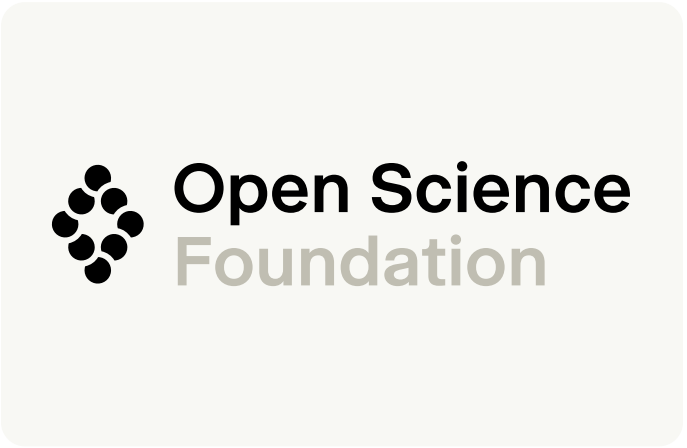
THE FIXED RELATIONSHIP

Dots, name and proportion.

The black mark, black first line and warm gray second line are supplied artwork. Preserve their geometry and colour.

THREE FORMS / SIX SOURCE FILES

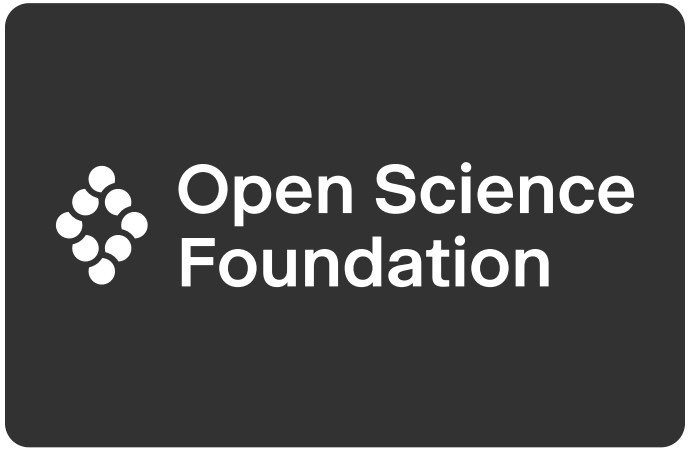
The supplied family.



01 / POSITIVE

Light surfaces

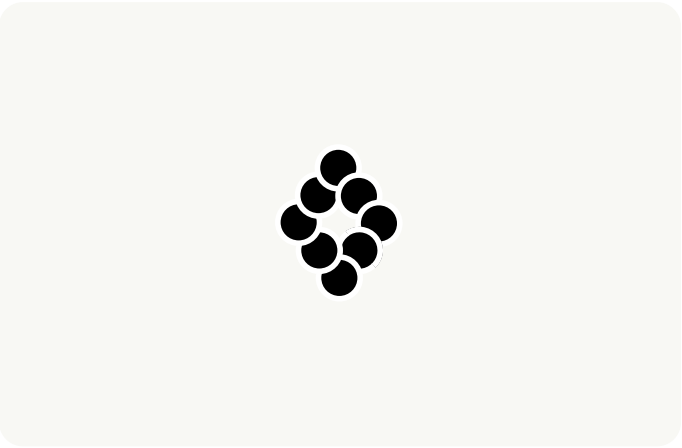
Original SVG + transparent PNG.



02 / NEGATIVE

Dark surfaces

Original SVG + transparent PNG.



03 / WEBSITE MARK

Compact contexts

Static reduced-motion SVG + PNG.

ALL SIX FILES ARE RETAINED UNCHANGED IN ASSETS/LOGO. ANIMATED FORMATIONS ARE MOTION ASSETS, NOT EXTRA STATIC LOGOS.

CHOOSE BY CONTEXT

Use the right form.



WHEN THE FOUNDATION SPEAKS

Full positive signature

Use on reports, decks, social graphics and correspondence. It is the default when the foundation needs to be named.



WHEN THE SURFACE IS DARK

Full negative signature

Use the supplied negative master on charcoal. Keep both lines readable and preserve the original colours.



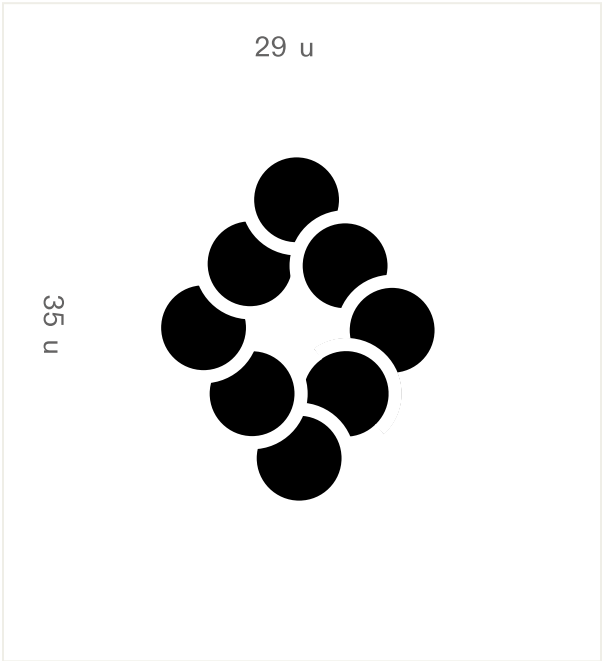
WHEN THE NAME IS ALREADY NEARBY

Compact website mark

Use for compact navigation and similar small spaces. Keep an accessible name for links and controls.

MEASURED FROM THE SUPPLIED MASTER

Preserve the original geometry.



COMPACT SVG / ORIGINAL VIEWBOX. u = SVG USER UNITS.

MASTER DIMENSIONS

519.74 × 236.98 u	Full positive SVG viewBox
394.49 × 85.25 u	Visible positive artwork, geometric bounds
29 × 35 u	Compact website mark viewBox

The full master includes generous outer canvas. A faithful export may remove unused canvas, provided the artwork and final clear space remain intact.

Keep the dot overlaps, outline detail and wordmark relationship. Always place the supplied artwork.

SPACE IS PART OF THE APPLICATION

Give the signature room.



APPLICATION RULE

At least one mark-width.

Let x equal the visible width of the dot mark in the full lockup. Leave at least x free on every side of the visible artwork.

ALIGNMENT

Use the visible artwork.

Align optically with text and other marks, then check the exclusion zone. Allow more room in quiet editorial layouts.

THIS IS THE EXISTING KIT'S APPLICATION RULE, NOT AN ORIGINAL DESIGNER MINIMUM-SIZE SPECIFICATION.

CHECK THE FINAL SIZE

Small use needs a clear name.



PRESENTATION REFERENCE / 230 PX

Full signature

The existing 1280 × 720 presentation recipe uses a 230 px-wide logo. This is a working reference, not a universal minimum.



WEBSITE STATIC MARK / 26, 30 & 33 PX HEIGHT

Compact response

Use the name nearby. The animated website canvas has 33, 37 and 40 px responsive display sizes; its static alternative uses 26, 30 and 33 px heights.

Proof the small wordmark line at actual output size. Increase the logo or simplify the surrounding layout if it becomes difficult to read.

THE SVG SPECIMEN WIDTH IS 230 CSS PX IN THE HTML SOURCE. THE PDF IS SCALED FOR READING.

PROTECT THE IDENTITY

Keep the mark intact.



LIGHT FIELD / ORIGINAL POSITIVE



CHARCOAL FIELD / ORIGINAL NEGATIVE

01

Keep proportions.

Do not stretch, rotate, skew or rebuild the lockup.

02

Keep the colours.

Use the supplied positive or negative artwork without recolouring.

03

Keep the detail.

Do not remove dots, close the gaps or add effects.

04

Keep the field quiet.

Use a clear surface, with enough space and contrast.

NO SHADOWS, GRADIENTS, OUTLINES OR NEW DESCRIPTORS. DO NOT TYPESET A REPLACEMENT WORDMARK.

A RESTRAINED FOUNDATION

Black, white and room to think.

BLACK

#1D1D1D

RGB 29 / 29 / 29. Ordinary text and visual weight.

WHITE

#FFFFFF

RGB 255 / 255 / 255. The main reading surface.

CREAM

#EFEEE7

RGB 239 / 238 / 231. Quiet supporting panels.

Build most compositions with a white surface and black text. Use cream-light and cream for calm groupings. Flat colour and generous space carry the system.

BLUE / #73ADFF

The website's identity and interaction accent. Use selectively. It is not a general small-text colour on white.

EXACT VALUES / CLEAR ROLES

Every colour has a job.

BLUE INK

#1C4E8F

Readable static blue text, references and links.

CREAM LIGHT

#F8F8F4

Soft fields and panels. RGB 248 / 248 / 244.

CHARCOAL

#323232

Dark surfaces and primary buttons. Pair with white.

GRAY

#646363

Secondary text where contrast permits.

CREAM DARK

#C0BEB2

Quiet details and the original wordmark treatment.

CREAM DARKER

#6F6E66

Secondary information on suitable light surfaces.

Gray light #EEEEEE

Yellow #E3BE00

Yellow light #FEFBE9

YELLOW BELONGS TO EXISTING LINK HOVER TREATMENTS. OPENTWIN RED IS EXCLUDED FROM FOUNDATION COMPOSITIONS.

DIGITAL CONTRAST

Make the words readable.

Aa

16.86:1

Black / white

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

12.82:1

White / charcoal

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

8.28:1

Blue ink / white

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

5.99:1

Gray / white

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

7.35:1

Black / blue

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

4.81:1

Cream darker / cream light

NORMAL TEXT

Aa

2.29:1

Blue / white

NOT FOR TEXT

Aa

2.29:1

White / blue

NOT FOR TEXT

Use at least 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text. Essential interface graphics and control boundaries need 3:1 against adjacent colours.

The homepage's light-blue "openness" is a retained identity treatment. For ordinary static blue text, use blue ink. Colour alone must not communicate status.

RATIOS CALCULATED FROM THE EXACT SRGB TOKENS. WCAG SOURCES / PAGE 26. LOGOTYPES HAVE A TEXT-CONTRAST EXCEPTION.

THE FOUNDATION TYPE PAIR

A human voice. A precise detail.

Aa

Selecta

Titles and body copy. Use Regular by default. Medium and Bold add selective emphasis.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789

Ag 01

ABC Diatype Semi Mono

Metadata, labels, captions and compact tables. Use Regular and Bold.

OPEN SCIENCE FOUNDATION
10 SEPTEMBER 2026

DESKTOP FAMILY / ABC DIATYPE SEMI MONO. WEBSITE CSS ALIAS / ABCDIATYPESEMIMONO. COMMERCIAL FONT FILES STAY EXTERNAL.

START WITH THE CANONICAL SCALE

Hierarchy, with a clear rhythm.

WEBSITE SCALE / AT A 16 PX ROOT

5xl	3.25 rem	52 px
4xl	2.5 rem	40 px
3xl	2.25 rem	36 px
2xl	1.875 rem	30 px
1xl	1.3125 rem	21 px
xl	1.125 rem	18 px
base	1 rem	16 px
sm	0.875 rem	14 px

MEDIUM ADAPTATIONS

Open science.

Shared knowledge.

A clear title, a short statement and a readable paragraph. Let space separate the levels.

Presentation roles: 78, 60, 45, 27 and 21 CSS px. Document roles: 27.5, 20.625, 14.4375, 11 and 9.625 pt.

These are existing template adaptations. Keep the website theme as the source for digital implementation.

TEXT-LG IS DELIBERATELY UNSET. DO NOT ADD NEW TYPEFACES OR TREAT A FALLBACK AS APPROVED FOUNDATION TYPOGRAPHY.

THE OWNER-SELECTED DEFAULT

A stable edge. Generous space.



ILLUSTRATIVE PRESENTATION GRID / SHOWN AT REDUCED SCALE.

01 / STRUCTURE

Keep titles left aligned.

Use one dominant title, a clear reading order and short paragraphs. Keep descriptions with their titles.

02 / SPACING

Use the existing rhythm.

Presentation outer margin: 60 px. Documents: 20 mm. Website spacing includes 10, 20, 30, 40, 60, 80, 100, 120 and 140 units.

03 / SURFACES

Stay flat and deliberate.

Use the 6, 12 and 16 px corner family. Avoid shadows, decorative rules beneath titles and coloured ribbons.

A VISUAL LANGUAGE FROM THE WEBSITE

Relationships, made visible.



OPENNESS / RINGS

54 particles

TRANSPARENCY / SPHERE

60 particles



COLLABORATION / TORUS KNOT

30 particles

REPRODUCIBILITY / CUBE GRID

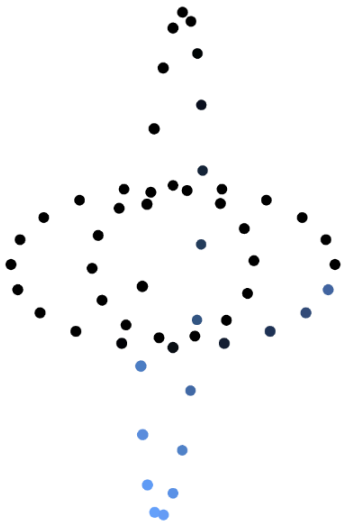
27 particles

The dot formations belong to the existing visual identity. Use the supplied animation source and its documented configurations. Keep the forms associated with their values.

These images are captured frames for reference. They do not expand the static logo family. The engine's highlight is #67A3FE, an original motion constant distinct from the CSS accent #73ADFF.

AN OPEN, CONTINUOUS PROCESS

Keep the original movement.



HERO / 54 PARTICLES / 8,000 MS IDLE

200 ms	600 ms	200 ms	4,000 ms
Gather	Pause	Expand	Values idle

The shared formation engine gathers to the centre, pauses as one dot and expands again. The hero uses an 8,000 ms idle interval. Keep its supplied easing and highlight behaviour.

The small logo is a separate system.

Its diamond, circle and radial formations gather over 200 ms and spread over 300 ms. Hover advances the forms; leaving returns to the diamond.

REDUCED MOTION

Retain the quiet alternative.

The hero is omitted, the values stop after a frame and the small logo uses a static SVG. Preserve these source behaviours.

EXPORTED MEDIA

Give the viewer control.

GIF and MP4 files do not detect preferences. Use a static alternative or explicit play/pause controls when embedding them.

REAL WORK, REAL CONTEXT

Show the place and the practice.



ETHERLAKEN / WEBSITE LOCATION FILM POSTER

FRAME

Use deliberate crops.

Preserve aspect ratio and choose a focal point. Keep captions distinct from images. Do not recolour photographs to match the palette.

CONTEXT

Keep the source visible.

Use approved images of research, people, tools and place. Keep their factual context and original credit where available.

MEDIA

Preserve separate rights.

This repository archives the five website MP4s and four existing posters. Their inclusion grants no new photograph or film licence.

SOURCE / OPENING-SCIENCE/HOMEPAGE, PUBLIC/VIDEOS/LOCATION-POSTER.JPG. LINK ETHERLAKEN TO ETHERLAKEN.COM/EN ON FIRST MENTION.

A CLEAR FIRST ENCOUNTER

The identity on screen.

Open Science
Foundation

Foundation Institute People

Advancing science through openness.

Scientific knowledge
as a global commons.

Explore the foundation



ILLUSTRATIVE STATIC APPLICATION. IT USES BLUE INK FOR READABLE BLUE TEXT; THE LIVE HOMEPAGE RETAINS ITS LIGHT-BLUE TAGLINE.

INTERFACE

One clear action.

Use the existing charcoal button treatment and visible keyboard focus. Keep text live and use meaningful link labels.

CONTAINERS

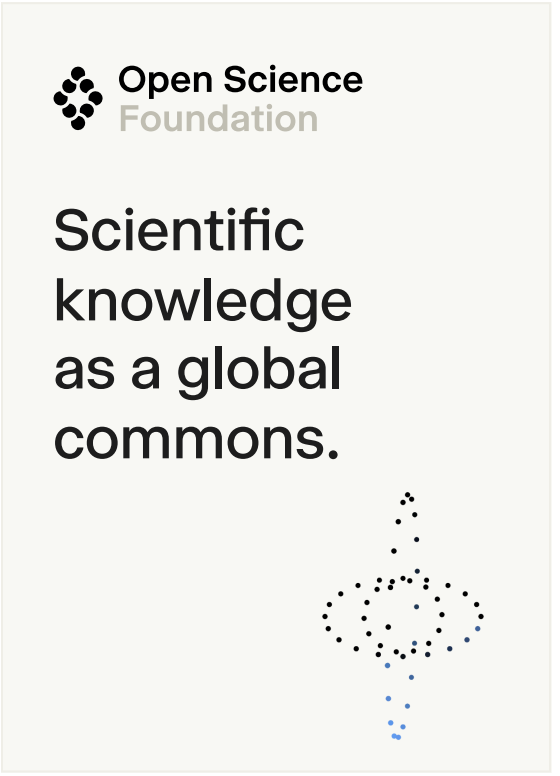
Use the website patterns.

container-main, container-narrow, container-wide and container-institute define the existing layout vocabulary.

PAPER, PROPORTION AND DETAIL

Clear enough to use every day.





DOCUMENTS

A4 and US Letter.

Use 20 mm margins and 11 pt Selecta body copy. ABC Diatype Semi Mono carries labels and metadata.

PRODUCTION

Proof the final output.

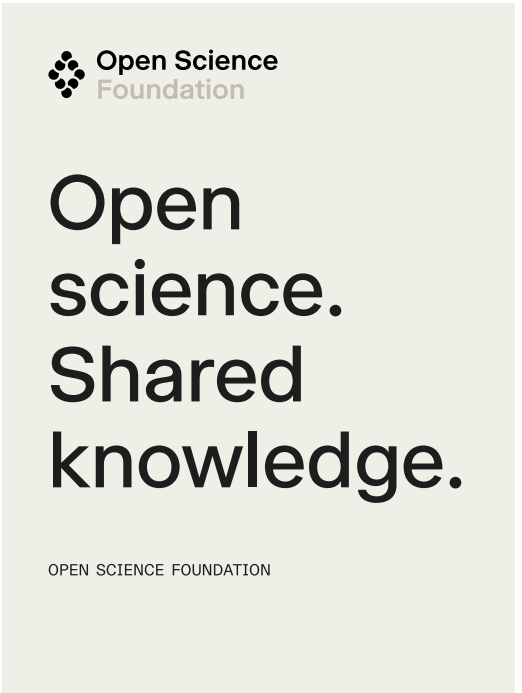
Check small text, clear space and page breaks. Use the printer's colour profile and add bleed if an application reaches the trim.

ILLUSTRATIVE DOCUMENT STUDIES. THE EXISTING EDITABLE OFFICE TEMPLATES REMAIN IN THE AUTHORISED EXTERNAL BRAND KIT.

SAME SYSTEM / DIFFERENT FORMATS

Let the message set the scale.





FORMATS

A consistent family.

Square: 1080 × 1080.
Portrait: 1080 × 1350.
Story: 1080 × 1920.
Landscape: 1200 × 630.

COMPOSITION

One dominant statement.

Keep the title left aligned, retain a clear signature and give the content room. Add factual context and accessible text when posting.

ILLUSTRATIVE APPLICATIONS / NOT PUBLISHED POSTS. VERIFY ALL DATES, NAMES, CLAIMS AND IMAGE CREDITS BEFORE USE.

MAKE THE RELATIONSHIP EXPLICIT

Share space with care.



01 / BALANCE

Optical size.

Balance marks by their visible weight. Preserve the clear space required by each identity, regardless of file dimensions.

02 / RELATIONSHIP

Say who does what.

Use a factual relationship label. Do not imply endorsement, funding or affiliation through placement alone.

03 / ACCESS

Name the destination.

For a link to the foundation’s home page, use “Open Science Foundation home”. If adjacent text repeats the name, avoid duplicate announcements.

ILLUSTRATIVE CO-BRANDING ARRANGEMENT. USE ORIGINAL PARTNER ARTWORK AND CONFIRMED RELATIONSHIPS.

A KIT MADE TO BE USED

From master to application.

LOGO MASTERS	assets/logo/	6 original SVG and PNG files with provenance.
MOTION PACKAGE	assets/motion/	6 animations, original source, preview and media.
DESIGN TOKENS	tokens/	Exact CSS colours, typography and layout recipes.
PDF & SOURCE	docs/	Dated guide, HTML print source and editable prose.
WEB STARTER	web-harness/	Existing Nuxt starter, components and checks.

Before exporting

Use the original signature.
Keep one mark-width clear.
Apply Selecta and Semi Mono.
Use the exact colour tokens.
Check contrast and reading order.
Retain reduced-motion behaviour.
Proof every page at final size.
Verify sources and rights.
Keep the dated edition together.

NO COMMERCIAL FONT BINARIES ARE BUNDLED. THE DISTRIBUTED PDF USES VECTOR OUTLINES. TEXT REMAINS EDITABLE IN THE SOURCE.

BUILT FROM THE EXISTING IDENTITY

An identity to work with.

Edition 01 translates the foundation's existing brand system into a visual reference, dated 10 September 2026.

The 27-page format and subject sequence take inspiration from the supplied ISCC guide. The identity, copy, artwork and practical rules here come from the foundation's sources and this edition's clearly labelled application studies.

DESIGN CREDITS

Visual identity: Martin Golombek.
Identity realisation and founding website graphic design: Tom Walsh / Prolog.
Credits follow the foundation's People page.

RIGHTS & EDITION

Guide prose: CC BY 4.0. Original logo artwork retains the foundation's Brand Assets Permission. Website animation artwork and films retain their existing rights. Source code retains its scoped licences. Font software is not distributed.

01 / BRAND AUTHORITY

Foundation brand repository

Open-Science-Foundation-brand-guide
Base commit e97831e. Guide, tokens and original logos.

02 / WEBSITE SOURCE

opening.science

Foundation website · People and credits
Source: Opening-Science/homepage @ 282a767.
Canonical theme unchanged from the recorded snapshot.

03 / ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.2

Text contrast, SC 1.4.3
Non-text contrast, SC 1.4.11

04 / TYPE

Maxitype & Dinamo

Selecta / Maxitype EULA
ABC Diatype Semi Mono / Dinamo

THE ARTISTS BEHIND THE IDENTITY

Design & visual arts

We would like to acknowledge the artists behind our founding website.

Scientific Knowledge as a Global Commons

Under this title, the Basel-based visual artist Martin Golombek created the foundation's visual identity. At its heart is the animated logo, which embodies an open and continuous process, the way this foundation understands science itself.

The identity was realized, and the website's graphic design developed, by Tom Walsh, the designer behind Prolog, a design studio in Basel, Switzerland.

ATTRIBUTION / OPENING.SCIENCE / PEOPLE. ADDED 11 SEPTEMBER 2026.